PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (Error! Hyperlink reference not valid.) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Inflammatory blood parameters as prognostic factors for surgical site infection after primary hip or knee arthroplasty: a systematic review protocol
AUTHORS	Domecky, Petr; Rejman Patkova, Anna; Mala-Ladova, Katerina; Maly, Josef

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Rodriguez-Merchan, E. La Paz University Hospital
REVIEW RETURNED	20-Jan-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	It is paramount to clearly define "surgical site infection" and therefore develop all the study based on such a clear definition. Otherwise, the conclusions will not be scientifically valid (will be confusing)

REVIEWER	Porter, Martyn Wrightington Hospital, Centre for Hip Surgery
REVIEW RETURNED	31-Jan-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	I think this is a well prepared protocol I am slightly concerned that there wi

REVIEWER	Sebastian, Sujeesh Lund University, Clinical Sciences
REVIEW RETURNED	06-Feb-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	In the protocol entitled “Inflammatory blood parameters as prognostic factors for surgical site infection after primary hip or knee arthroplasty: a systematic review protocol” Domecky et al describes about a systematic review aiming to determine whether inflammatory blood parameters could discriminate between normal postoperative inflammation and SSI after primary hip or knee arthroplasty. The research is original and is well written and planned. I have few comments or suggestions for the authors to consider: Abstract: a. Where ever necessary, expand all the abbreviations used first time in the protocol.

	b. Page no. 4, Line 12: Is it c-reactive protein or C-reactive protein? Introduction: a. The standard definition of SSI following hip or knee arthroplasty could be added. Subgroup analysis: a. Other than the mentioned IBP in the study, authors could also consider the relation of other IBP's (like IL-8, IL-1β etc) prognostic value for SSI as well. b. Among the various study characteristic, it is assumed that authors will take note of the ASA scores, duration of surgery, and dose and timing of antibiotic prophylaxis.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Reviewer: 1
Dr. E. Rodriguez-Merchan, La Paz University Hospital

Authors´ comment: Thank you for this comment. We added the clear definition for SSI in the Introduction as well as Types of outcomes measures to have scientifically valid conclusions as you suggested. Moreover, the definition for periprosthetic joint infection as subcategory of SSI was added according to definitions by MSIS, IDSA, ICM and Parvazi et al. (2018).

Reviewer: 2
Mr. Martyn Porter, Wrightington Hospital

Authors´ comment: Thank you for this comment. Unfortunately, since the comments have been cut off, there is nothing to discuss or review.

Reviewer: 3
Dr, Sujeesh Sebastian, Lund University

Abstract:

Authors´ comment: Thank you for all these comments. We corrected all the abbreviations accordingly (while to maintain word count requirements) as well as the C-reactive protein.

Introduction:

Authors´ comment: We added the clear definition for SSI in the Introduction as well as Types of outcomes measures to have scientifically valid conclusions as you suggested. Moreover, the definition for periprosthetic joint infection as subcategory of SSI was added according to definitions by MSIS, IDSA, ICM and Parvazi et al. (2018).

Subgroup analysis:

Authors´ comment: Other than the mentioned IBP will be certainly considered as we used search terms: inflammatory marker; biological markers or hematologic tests. However, the primary IBP was defined based on the routine screening tests provided in clinical practice. The study-level characteristics were updaed with terms “duration of surgery” and “ASA score”. Furthermore, the characteristics of the term “antibiotic prophylaxis” were precisely defined based on the reviewer´s suggestions.

Additionally, the authors corrected some typo and language style to improve the readiness of the manuscript. We hope that these revisions improve the paper such that you now deem it worthy of publication in BMJ Open.

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Sebastian, Sujeesh Lund University, Clinical Sciences
REVIEW RETURNED	17-Jul-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	No comments.